



Duke

You've seen him around, but don't recognize him over the coffee icon, he's the Java mascot



Greenfoot

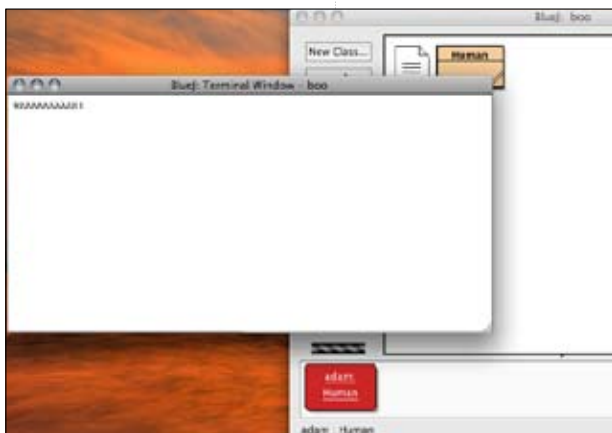
If you like BlueJ, be sure to check out Greenfoot, another educational Java dev environment



Learn Java

Interested in more code? Head over to www.javaworld.com

Developer Corner



This birth is easier than most

You'll now see your Human's first wail in the BlueJ terminal.

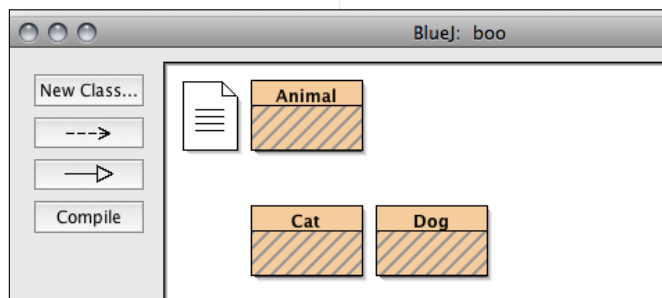
To see the properties of this Human, double-click on it.

To have the Human say something, right-click on it and choose void saySomething(String something). In the dialog, type in what you want the object to say, enclosed in double quotes.

As you get better with Java, you can create and modify the fields and methods as you please. Meanwhile...

Inheritance

Classes don't need to be the Ultimate Definition of Everything. In fact, classes are supposed to be generic, and if there are any specific properties or methods you need in a class, you create sub-classes that inherit from the original class. All animals, for example, have a certain number of legs (two, four, and so on), and they all walk. But dogs bark, and cats meow, and yet, they're both animals. In programming, we



Getting the classes ready

create one class for animals with all the properties and methods that are the same across all animals, and separate classes for dogs and cats, with all the properties that are specific only to them. In BlueJ, it's just like creating any other class.

Once you've created the classes in BlueJ, getting Dog and Cat to inherit from Animal is easy enough: click on the Insert and Inheritance Relation button (the solid arrow), click on Dog first, then click on Animal. You'll see an arrow pointing from Dog to Animal. Repeat this for every class needs to inherit from Animal. Now, when you create a new Dog (for example), you'll be able to run the methods from Dog and Animal.

The abstract class

When you're creating generic classes like Animal, you don't really want to create objects of that class—instead, you want other class to inherit from it, and create objects from those, instead. In such situations, you create abstract classes, which you can't create objects from, but can still inherit from.

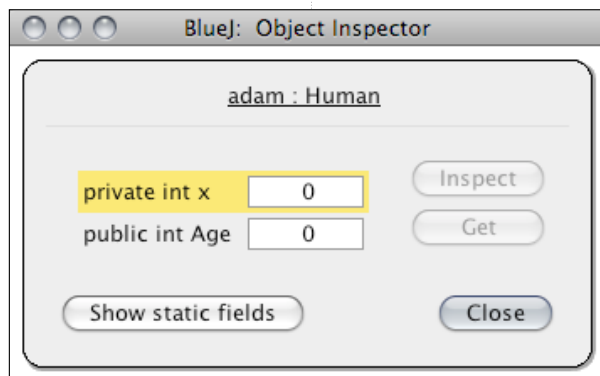
When you create a class in BlueJ, choose the Abstract Class option to create an abstract class. If you're going to turn an already existing class into an abstract class, go to the editor and change the definition from:

```
public class Animal
```

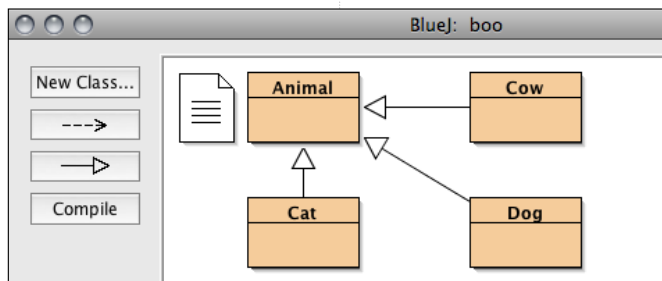
 to:

```
public abstract class Animal
```

And now, all you have to do is have BlueJ around while you're learning Java.



You can see your Human's properties in the Object Inspector



Dogs will inherit all the "qualities" of Animals

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